Module 0

Startup Autopsy

A joint initiative by

WORKSHOP: The 90 Minutes

5m Scene Setting

Startup graveyard framing + case study distribution

20m Autopsy Phase

Teams analyze assigned failed startup case study

15m Report Out

90 seconds per team, hard-timed: cause of death → pattern

15m Debrief

Which kill criterion would have fired — and in which week?

25m First Signal

Draft + SEND 3 messages to real people about a frustration

10m Setup

Student Toolkit + commit to 3 problem hypotheses

Discussion Sparks

“What’s the difference between a startup that dies at €10M revenue vs €0?”

“If you could only save ONE of these startups, which one and how?”

“Why do smart TUM engineers keep building things nobody wants?”

Today’s Deliverable

MUST PRODUCE:

Completed autopsy sheet + 3 problem hypotheses + 3 First-Signal messages SENT

KILL CRITERIA:

You can’t name a single real human who has this problem

This Week’s Deep Work

- Read PG ‘How to Get Startup Ideas’
- Identify 3 problems you personally experience
- Talk to 2 people about their daily frustrations

Complete by next session — or you’re behind.